



DUSSEHRA

(Vijayadashami) — Seven Speech Essays for the School Assembly
CEFR A1 to C2 & Phrasal Verbs Special

Colour Guide

Red bold italic = CEFR level words | **Green bold** = phrasal verbs
Each essay: Introduction · Body · Conclusion · Word count · Word list with
English & Hindi meanings

#	Level	Description	Words
1	A1	Beginner	263
2	A2	Elementary	288
3	B1	Intermediate	288
4	B2	Upper-Intermediate	286
5	C1	Advanced	264
6	C2	Proficiency	292
7	Phrasal Verbs	Phrasal Verbs Special	351

Version 1 · CEFR A1 · Beginner

Highlighted in **RED bold italic**: A1 level words

Dussehra: A Speech for the School Assembly

INTRODUCTION

Good morning, respected Principal, dear teachers and my **friends**. Today I will speak about Dussehra. Dussehra is a big **festival** in India. It comes in September or October. Everyone is **happy** on this day. It is my favourite festival, and I want to tell you about it.

BODY

Dussehra is a **story** about Lord Ram. Ravan is a bad **king**. He takes Sita to his big house. Ram is a good man, and he is very **strong**. His **brother** Lakshman and Hanuman help him. Ram fights Ravan for many days. At last, Ram wins. Good wins over bad. This is the message of Dussehra.

On Dussehra, we go to a big ground. We see a very tall Ravan made of paper. In the evening, the people burn him. There is a lot of **fire** and noise. Children clap and shout. After that, we eat **sweets** and good food. We wear new clothes. There is also a **fair** near my house. We buy toys and balloons there. My **family** goes together, and we have a lot of fun.

Before Dussehra, there are nine days of Navratri. People pray to Goddess Durga. They sing and dance in the evening. On the tenth day, it is Dussehra. Many people also go to the temple in the morning. It is a very special time for my family and me.

CONCLUSION

Dussehra teaches us to be good. We must tell the truth. We must help other people. We must not do bad things. Let us be like Ram. Thank you for listening to me. Happy Dussehra to all of you!

Word Count: **263 words**

CEFR A1 Word List — English & Hindi Meanings

#	Word	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
1	friend	A person you know well and like	दोस्त
2	festival	A special day or time when people celebrate	त्योहार
3	happy	Feeling good and pleased	खुश
4	story	Words that tell about events	कहानी
5	king	A man who rules a country	राजा
6	strong	Having a lot of power	ताकतवर / मजबूत
7	brother	A boy or man with the same parents as you	भाई

#	Word	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
8	<i>fire</i>	Flames that burn and give heat	आग
9	<i>sweet</i>	Sugary food, such as laddoo	मिठाई
10	<i>fair</i>	A place with games, shops and fun	मेला
11	<i>family</i>	Parents, children and close relatives	परिवार

Version 2 · CEFR A2 · Elementary

Highlighted in **RED bold italic**: A2 level words

Dussehra: A Speech for the School Assembly

INTRODUCTION

Good morning to our respected Principal, teachers and my dear classmates. Today, I am going to talk about one of the most **popular** festivals in India, Dussehra. We **celebrate** it every year in September or October, and I have loved it since I was a small child.

BODY

The story of Dussehra is very old. Long ago, a demon king named Ravan **kidnapped** Sita, the wife of Lord Ram. Ravan was clever, but he was also very proud and **cruel**. Ram was **brave** and kind. With the help of his brother Lakshman and his monkey friend Hanuman, he travelled a long way and fought a big battle. Finally, Ram **defeated** Ravan on the tenth day. That is why people call this day Vijayadashami, the day of victory.

Every year, my family **prepares** for Dussehra many days before. My mother cooks special food, and my father takes us to see the Ramlila. In the Ramlila, actors show the whole story of Ram on a stage. Last year, I saw it with my cousins, and I **enjoyed** it a lot. On the last day, the **neighbours** and their children gather in a big ground. We watch a large statue of Ravan burn with fireworks. The noise is loud, but the sky looks beautiful. Some people **decorate** their homes and offer prayers, too.

CONCLUSION

Dussehra gives us an **important** lesson. Bad people may look strong for some time, but good always wins in the end. We should be **honest, polite** and helpful to everyone. If we do good things every day, we will become good people, and our country will become better. I hope you will all enjoy this festival with your families this year. Thank you very much for listening. Happy Dussehra!

Word Count: **288 words**

CEFR A2 Word List — English & Hindi Meanings

#	Word	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
1	popular	Liked by many people	लोकप्रिय
2	celebrate	Do something special for a happy day	उत्सव मनाना
3	kidnap	Take a person away by force	अपहरण करना
4	cruel	Causing pain without kindness	क्रूर / निर्दयी
5	brave	Not afraid of danger	बहादुर
6	defeat	Win against someone	हराना

#	Word	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
7	<i>prepare</i>	Get ready for something	तैयारी करना
8	<i>enjoy</i>	Get pleasure from something	आनंद लेना
9	<i>neighbour</i>	A person who lives next to you	पड़ोसी
10	<i>decorate</i>	Make something look nice	सजाना
11	<i>important</i>	Having great value or meaning	महत्वपूर्ण
12	<i>honest</i>	Always telling the truth	ईमानदार
13	<i>polite</i>	Showing good manners	विनम्र

Version 3 · CEFR B1 · Intermediate

Highlighted in **RED bold italic**: B1 level words

Dussehra: A Speech for the School Assembly

INTRODUCTION

Good morning, respected Principal, honourable teachers and my dear friends. It is a great pleasure to stand before you today to speak about Dussehra, a festival that **symbolises** the **victory** of good over **evil**. As we all know, this festival brings our whole **community** together, and I would like to share why it matters so much to us.

BODY

Dussehra, also known as Vijayadashami, comes after nine nights of Navratri. It is based on the **ancient epic**, the Ramayana. According to the story, Lord Ram was sent to the forest for fourteen years. During that time, the demon king Ravan kidnapped his wife Sita. Ravan was a learned scholar, but his ego and greed destroyed him. Ram gathered an army of monkeys and bears, and after a long war he killed Ravan. In some parts of India, people also remember Goddess Durga, who defeated the demon Mahishasura on this day.

The celebrations are wonderful and different in every region. In North India, huge figures of Ravan, Kumbhakarna and Meghnad are burnt after the Ramlila performances. In Bengal, people bid an emotional farewell to Goddess Durga, and in Mysore there is a grand **procession** of decorated elephants. This **tradition** is passed from one **generation** to the next, so children learn our **culture** naturally. However, I believe the real meaning is not in burning a paper figure. The real Ravan lives inside us as anger, jealousy and dishonesty, and we must defeat him first.

CONCLUSION

To conclude, Dussehra reminds us that **honesty**, **courage** and kindness are stronger than power and pride. Let us promise ourselves today that we will follow these **values** in school and at home. Thank you for your kind attention, and I wish you all a very happy Dussehra.

Word Count: **288 words**

CEFR B1 Word List — English & Hindi Meanings

#	Word	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
1	symbolise	Represent an idea or quality	प्रतीक होना
2	victory	Success in a fight or contest	विजय
3	evil	Very bad and harmful behaviour	बुराई / दुष्टता
4	community	People living in one area, sharing things	समुदाय

#	Word	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
5	<i>ancient</i>	Very old; from a long time ago	प्राचीन
6	<i>epic</i>	A long story about heroes and great events	महाकाव्य
7	<i>procession</i>	A line of people moving in a public event	जुलूस
8	<i>tradition</i>	A custom passed down over time	परंपरा
9	<i>generation</i>	People born and living at about the same time	पीढ़ी
10	<i>culture</i>	The customs, arts and way of life of a group	संस्कृति
11	<i>honesty</i>	The quality of telling the truth	ईमानदारी
12	<i>courage</i>	Ability to face fear or danger	साहस
13	<i>value</i>	A belief about what is right and important	मूल्य

Version 4 · CEFR B2 · Upper-Intermediate

Highlighted in **RED bold italic**: B2 level words

Dussehra: A Speech for the School Assembly

INTRODUCTION

Good morning, respected Principal, esteemed teachers and my dear fellow students. Standing here today, I feel genuinely honoured to speak on Dussehra, a festival whose **significance** goes far beyond fireworks and fairs. It is a yearly opportunity to **reflect** on the **moral** choices we make every day.

BODY

Dussehra **commemorates** Lord Ram's **triumph** over the ten-headed king Ravan, as narrated in the Ramayana. What makes the story remarkable is that Ravan was not ignorant; he was a gifted scholar and a powerful ruler. Yet his **arrogance** and **obsession** led to his downfall. This **demonstrates** that talent without **integrity** is meaningless. Meanwhile, Ram faced years of **adversity**, including exile and separation from his wife, yet he never abandoned his principles. His **perseverance** is a lesson for every student who struggles with exams or setbacks.

The festival is also wonderfully **diverse**. In Delhi, thousands gather to watch towering effigies burst into flames, whereas in Kolkata, devotees immerse Durga idols in the river with deep emotion. In Kullu, a week-long celebration brings villagers together with their local deities. Despite these differences, the underlying message **reinforces** the same **universal** idea: injustice cannot last forever. Furthermore, these gatherings strengthen **solidarity** among neighbours, because people from different backgrounds celebrate side by side. In my opinion, we should also make Dussehra more **sustainable**, using eco-friendly materials, so that we do not harm the environment while celebrating.

CONCLUSION

In conclusion, Dussehra challenges us to look inward. Each of us must **cultivate** the courage to speak the truth, the discipline to work hard, and the compassion to help others. If we can defeat our inner weaknesses, we will have honoured the true spirit of this festival. Thank you for listening, and I wish everyone a meaningful Dussehra.

Word Count: **286 words**

CEFR B2 Word List — English & Hindi Meanings

#	Word	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
1	significance	Special meaning or importance	महत्व
2	reflect	Think carefully about something	चिंतन करना
3	moral	Concerned with right and wrong	नैतिक

#	Word	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
4	commemorate	Honour the memory of an event or person	स्मरण करना
5	triumph	A great victory or success	विजय / जीत
6	arrogance	Too much pride in yourself	अहंकार
7	obsession	Thinking about one thing all the time	जुनून
8	demonstrate	Show something clearly	सिद्ध करना / दिखाना
9	integrity	Being honest with strong moral principles	सत्यनिष्ठा
10	adversity	Difficulty or misfortune	विपत्ति
11	perseverance	Continuing to try despite difficulty	दृढ़ता
12	diverse	Having many different kinds	विविध
13	reinforce	Make something stronger	मज़बूत करना
14	universal	True or suitable for everyone	सार्वभौमिक
15	solidarity	Unity and support among people	एकजुटता
16	sustainable	Not harming the environment for the future	टिकाऊ
17	cultivate	Develop a quality or skill with care	विकसित करना

Version 5 · CEFR C1 · Advanced

Highlighted in **RED bold italic**: C1 level words

Dussehra: A Speech for the School Assembly

INTRODUCTION

Good morning, respected Principal, distinguished faculty and my exceptionally bright peers. It is with genuine pride that I address you on Dussehra, a festival that **encapsulates** the age-old struggle between virtue and vice. Few celebrations across our subcontinent **resonate** so **profoundly** with people of every region, language and generation.

BODY

At its core, Dussehra recounts the defeat of Ravan by Lord Ram, yet the epic is far more nuanced than a simple **dichotomy** of hero and villain. Ravan was learned, devout and formidable; it was his unchecked arrogance, not his ignorance, that sealed his fate. Ram, by contrast, **embodies unwavering** commitment to duty, even when duty demands personal sacrifice. The narrative therefore invites us to **scrutinise** our own conduct, rather than merely to condemn a distant villain.

The festival's cultural **legacy** is equally remarkable. From the **elaborate** Ramlila performances of Uttar Pradesh to the immersion of Goddess Durga in Bengal, the celebrations **transcend** geographical and religious boundaries. The burning of towering effigies is, admittedly, **ephemeral**: within minutes, months of painstaking craftsmanship turn to ash. Yet the ritual's message is **enduring**, precisely because the flames are symbolic rather than literal. In an age where misinformation and moral compromise seem increasingly **pervasive**, this ancient reminder feels strikingly contemporary.

CONCLUSION

Let us therefore treat Dussehra not as a spectacle to be watched but as a standard to be met. Each of us harbours a private Ravan in the form of pride, prejudice or **complacency**. Confronting him honestly is the most **authentic** way to honour this festival. Thank you for your gracious attention, and may this Vijayadashami inspire us all.

Word Count: **264 words**

CEFR C1 Word List — English & Hindi Meanings

#	Word	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
1	encapsulate	Express the essence of something briefly	सार समेटना
2	resonate	Have a deep meaning for someone	मन को छूना / गूँजना
3	profoundly	In a very deep or serious way	गहराई से
4	dichotomy	A division into two opposite parts	द्वंद्व / दो विपरीत भाग

#	Word	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
5	<i>embody</i>	Be a perfect example of a quality	मूर्त रूप देना
6	<i>unwavering</i>	Steady and not changing	अडिग
7	<i>scrutinise</i>	Examine something very carefully	बारीकी से जाँचना
8	<i>legacy</i>	Something passed down from the past	विरासत
9	<i>elaborate</i>	Detailed and complicated	विस्तृत / जटिल
10	<i>transcend</i>	Go beyond limits or boundaries	पार कर जाना
11	<i>ephemeral</i>	Lasting for a very short time	क्षणभंगुर
12	<i>enduring</i>	Lasting for a long time	चिरस्थायी
13	<i>pervasive</i>	Spreading widely through everything	व्यापक
14	<i>complacency</i>	Feeling so satisfied that you stop trying	आत्मसंतुष्टि / लापरवाही
15	<i>authentic</i>	Genuine; real	प्रामाणिक

Version 6 · CEFR C2 · Proficiency

Highlighted in **RED bold italic**: C2 level words

Dussehra: A Speech for the School Assembly

INTRODUCTION

Good morning, respected Principal, esteemed faculty and my **erudite** fellow students. It is a distinct privilege to speak on Dussehra, the **quintessential** Indian festival, in which myth, morality and collective memory **converge** beneath a sky ablaze with fireworks. Few occasions so **ineluctably** compel a society to examine its conscience.

BODY

The Ramayana tells of Ravan, a scholar of formidable **sagacity** whose **hubris** rendered him blind to the consequences of his **perfidy**. By abducting Sita, he violated not merely a woman's freedom but the entire moral order that sustains a civilisation. Against him stands Ram, **indomitable** yet restrained, whose victory is won not through cruelty but through **rectitude**. The epic thereby suggests that true power is inseparable from ethical responsibility, and that the **vicissitudes** of fortune cannot diminish a person who remains loyal to principle.

What is most striking is the festival's **ubiquity** and its **kaleidoscopic** variety. In Kullu, deities are carried in **resplendent** processions; in Bengal, Durga's immersion carries an almost elegiac tenderness; in Mysuru, royal pageantry recalls a bygone grandeur. Beneath this **panoply** lies a **cathartic** ritual: as the effigies collapse in flames, the crowd experiences a shared release, a symbolic **repudiation** of malice. Yet we would be naive to imagine that evil is so readily consumed. It is **insidious**; it hides in prejudice, indifference and small dishonesties, and it demands vigilance far more enduring than a single evening's spectacle.

CONCLUSION

Let us, then, resist the temptation to treat Dussehra as mere pageantry. Its enduring wisdom **exhorts** each of us to **vanquish** the Ravan within: the vanity, envy and apathy that quietly erode our better selves. If we can do that, the festival will have achieved its highest purpose. I thank you for your gracious attention and wish you a most reflective Vijayadashami.

Word Count: **292 words**

CEFR C2 Word List — English & Hindi Meanings

#	Word	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
1	erudite	Having or showing great knowledge	विद्वान
2	quintessential	The perfect example of something	सर्वोत्कृष्ट उदाहरण

#	Word	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
3	converge	Come together at one point	एक बिंदु पर मिलना
4	ineluctably	In a way that cannot be avoided	अपरिहार्य रूप से
5	sagacity	Wisdom and good judgement	प्रज्ञा / विवेक
6	hubris	Excessive pride that leads to downfall	दंभ / अति-अहंकार
7	perfidy	Deceitful betrayal of trust	विश्वासघात
8	indomitable	Impossible to defeat or discourage	अजेय / अदम्य
9	rectitude	Morally correct behaviour	सदाचार
10	vicissitudes	Changes of fortune in life	उतार-चढ़ाव
11	ubiquity	Being present everywhere	सर्वव्यापकता
12	kaleidoscopic	Full of changing, varied colours or patterns	बहुवर्णी
13	resplendent	Brilliantly bright and splendid	भव्य / दैदीप्यमान
14	panoply	An impressive collection or display	भव्य प्रदर्शन
15	cathartic	Relieving strong emotions	भावनाओं को शुद्ध करने वाला
16	repudiation	A firm rejection of something	पूर्ण अस्वीकार
17	insidious	Harmful in a hidden, gradual way	छिपकर हानि पहुँचाने वाला
18	exhort	Strongly urge someone to do something	प्रेरित / आग्रह करना
19	vanquish	Defeat completely	पूरी तरह पराजित करना

Version 7 · Phrasal Verbs Special

Highlighted in **GREEN bold**: phrasal verbs

Dussehra: A Speech for the School Assembly

INTRODUCTION

Good morning, respected Principal, teachers and dear friends. I have been **looking forward to** this moment for weeks, because today I get to **speak up** about my favourite festival, Dussehra. Every year, it **comes around** in autumn and **brings together** our families and neighbours. Let me **lay out** why it matters so much.

BODY

The story **goes back** thousands of years. When Ram was **sent away** to the forest, the demon king Ravan **carried off** his wife Sita. Ram did not **give up**. He gathered his courage, **gathered up** an army with Hanuman's help, and **took on** Ravan in a great war. Ravan **held on to** his pride until the very end, but he finally **went down** fighting, and goodness **won out**. Even today, we **look up to** Ram because he **stood up for** what was right and never **backed down**.

As Dussehra **draws near**, the whole town **wakes up** with excitement. Volunteers **put up** tall stages for the Ramlila, artists **put together** enormous figures of Ravan from bamboo and paper, and families **do up** their homes with flowers. My grandmother always **gets up** early to **cook up** special sweets, and we all **dress up** in our best clothes. On the big evening, huge crowds **turn up** at the ground and **cheer on** the actors. When the fireworks **go off**, the effigy **goes up** in flames, and then it **burns down** completely while everyone **lights up** with joy. After that, we **hang out** at the fair, **stock up on** sweets and **catch up with** old friends. In this way, traditions **live on** because each generation **passes on** its stories to the next.

CONCLUSION

So, what should we **take away** from Dussehra? First, never **give in** to fear or greed. Second, when life **lets us down**, we must **bounce back** and **carry on**. Third, we should **own up** to our mistakes, **work out** our differences peacefully, and **look after** one another. If we **live up to** these ideals, we can **bring about** a better world and **wipe out** the Ravan within us. Thank you for listening, and I wish you all a joyful Dussehra!

Word Count: **351 words**

Phrasal Verbs Used — English & Hindi Meanings

#	Phrasal Verb	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
1	look forward to	Be excited about something in the future	उत्सुकता से प्रतीक्षा करना
2	speak up	Say your opinion openly	खुलकर बोलना

#	Phrasal Verb	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
3	come around	Happen again regularly	फिर आ जाना
4	bring together	Unite people	एक साथ लाना
5	lay out	Explain clearly and in order	विस्तार से बताना
6	go back	Have origins far in the past	की शुरुआत होना
7	send away	Make someone leave	दूर भेज देना
8	carry off	Take away by force	उठा ले जाना
9	give up	Stop trying	हार मान लेना
10	gather up	Collect together	इकट्ठा करना
11	take on	Fight or challenge	मुकाबला करना
12	hold on to	Keep hold of	थामे रखना
13	go down	Be defeated	(लड़ते हुए) गिर जाना
14	win out	Succeed in the end	अंत में जीतना
15	look up to	Admire and respect	सम्मान करना
16	stand up for	Defend or support	पक्ष में खड़े होना
17	back down	Withdraw from a position	पीछे हट जाना
18	draw near	Come closer in time or place	पास आना
19	wake up	Become awake and alert	जाग उठना
20	put up	Build or erect	खड़ा करना
21	put together	Assemble	जोड़कर बनाना
22	do up	Decorate or improve	सजाना-सँवारना
23	get up	Rise from bed	उठना
24	cook up	Prepare food quickly	झटपट पकाना
25	dress up	Wear special clothes	सज-धजकर तैयार होना
26	turn up	Arrive	आ पहुँचना
27	cheer on	Encourage by shouting	हौसला बढ़ाना
28	go off	Explode or make a sudden sound	फटना / बज उठना
29	go up	Burst or rise, as in flames	(आग में) जल उठना
30	burn down	Be destroyed by fire	जलकर राख होना
31	light up	Become bright or happy	चमक उठना
32	hang out	Spend time relaxing with others	साथ समय बिताना
33	stock up on	Buy a large supply of	भंडार कर लेना
34	catch up with	Talk to update each other	मिलकर हालचाल लेना
35	live on	Continue to exist	जीवित रहना
36	pass on	Give to the next person	आगे सौंपना
37	take away	Learn as a lesson	सीख लेना
38	give in	Surrender	झुक जाना
39	let down	Disappoint	निराश करना

#	Phrasal Verb	English Meaning	हिंदी अर्थ
40	bounce back	Recover quickly	फिर उबर आना
41	carry on	Continue	जारी रखना
42	own up	Admit a mistake	गलती स्वीकारना
43	work out	Solve or resolve	सुलझाना
44	look after	Take care of	देखभाल करना
45	live up to	Meet expectations	अपेक्षा पर खरा उतरना
46	bring about	Cause to happen	घटित कराना
47	wipe out	Destroy completely	मिटा देना